



Medford City Council
Medford, Massachusetts

MEETING DATE

October 13, 2026

SPONSORED BY

Isaac Bears, Council President,
Justin Tseng, City Councilor

AGENDA ITEM

26-178 - Resolution to Discuss a PILOT and Community Benefits Framework for Medford

FULL TEXT AND DESCRIPTION

WHEREAS, the Medford City Council has previously sought to establish a more transparent and representative framework for Payments in Lieu of Taxes (PILOT), including through Papers 20-021 and 20-053, which resulted in the preparation of a draft PILOT Commission ordinance, and the Council's 2024–2025 Governing Agenda subsequently contemplated a Community Benefits Agreement Ordinance providing for community participation in negotiations with major development projects and nonprofit institutions; and

WHEREAS, Medford's last written PILOT agreement with Tufts University expired in 2018, the subsequent arrangement was not memorialized in a publicly available written agreement, and Medford currently lacks a permanent, publicly established process through which residents and the City Council can participate in defining and negotiating PILOT contributions and community benefits; and

WHEREAS, large nonprofit institutions and major development projects can have significant and lasting impacts on Medford's neighborhoods, housing, infrastructure, public services, and finances, and the City would benefit from a transparent and consistent framework for community participation, institutional dialogue, negotiated community benefits, and public accountability;

BE IT RESOLVED, that the Medford City Council discuss the development of a comprehensive PILOT and Community Benefits framework, including revisiting and updating the previously drafted PILOT Commission ordinance and developing a Community Benefits Agreement ordinance.

RECOMMENDATION

FISCAL IMPACT

ATTACHMENTS

None